

MTA Ridership Trends After COVID-19

Data Analysis Report: 2019–2025

Overview

This project analyzes MTA ridership data from 2019–2025 to understand how public transportation usage changed following the COVID-19 pandemic.

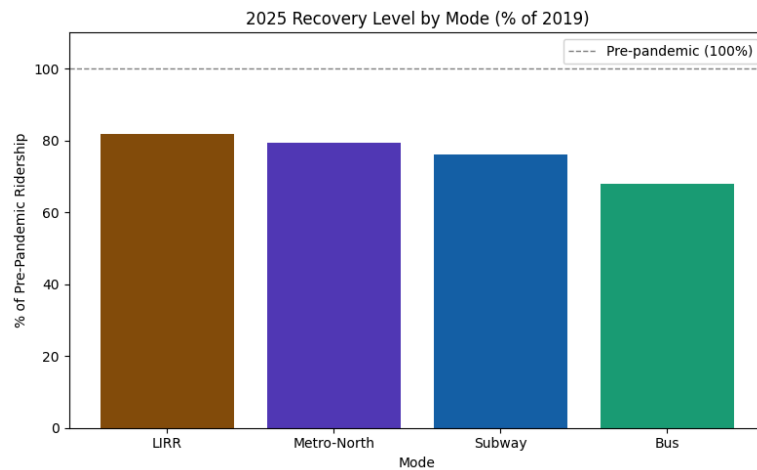
By examining travel patterns across different transit systems, the analysis answers two key questions:

1. Which MTA transit mode recovered the fastest after the pandemic?
2. Which transit system shows the biggest difference between weekday and weekend ridership?

The goal of this project is to turn transit data into clear, data-driven insights that highlight how commuting behavior and transportation demand evolved across New York City.

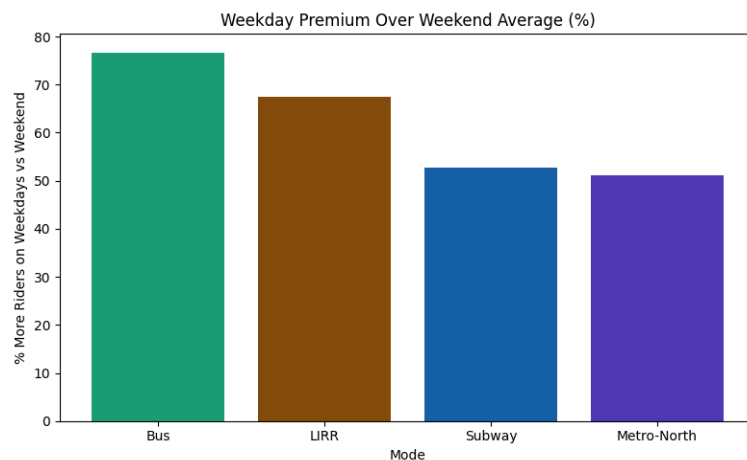
Q1: Which transit mode recovered fastest post-COVID?

Finding: The LIRR recovered the fastest, reaching 81.8% of its 2019 ridership levels by 2025.



Q2: Which mode has the most weekday vs. weekend variation?

Finding: Bus ridership shows the largest gap, with 76.7% more riders on weekdays than on weekends



CONCLUSION

Recovery across NYC transit has not been uniform. The LIRR rebounded quickest toward pre-pandemic levels, while bus ridership continues to recover more slowly. Bus also shows the strongest weekday dependence, suggesting it serves daily commuters more than any other mode. These findings highlight how commuting behavior has shifted since COVID-19 and how different systems are adapting to new travel patterns.

RECOMMENDATIONS

1. **Prioritize Bus recovery.** Bus is the slowest mode to recover at 68% of pre-pandemic levels. Expanding frequent routes and strengthening fare enforcement could help close the gap.
2. **Right-size weekend bus service.** Bus has the highest weekday premium at +76.7%, meaning weekend demand is significantly lower. Adjusting weekend schedules to match actual demand could reduce operating costs.

DATA SOURCES

All ridership figures used in this analysis were sourced from official MTA and New York State publications:

- **Annual Ridership (2019–2024):** MTA New York City Transit Subway & Bus Ridership Report — www.mta.info/agency/new-york-city-transit/subway-bus-ridership-2024
- **2025 Ridership Figures:** NY Governor's Office Press Release — www.governor.ny.gov/news/governor-hochul-highlights-record-breaking-year-performance-and-ridership-mta-2025
- **Weekday vs Weekend Figures:** MTA 2024 Annual Report — www.mta.info/press-release/mta-headquarters/mta-2024-annual-report
- **Raw Dataset:** MTA Daily Ridership Data (2020–present) via NY Open Data — www.data.ny.gov/Transportation/MTA-Daily-Ridership-Data-Beginning-2020/vxuj-8kew